Take Courage, *It Is I*

Take courage, it is I; do not be afraid.

▶ Watch on YouTube | Read Matthew 14:22-36 in the LSB | 22:42 | Channel: Every Word

Full title: Matthew 14:22-36 – Why Jesus Walked on Water (It's Not What You Think). Series: The Gospel of Matthew Every Word (playlist of 58 videos).

FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND (ADDED) · DEBATED · LSB TEXT · ◆ LOGOS FACTBOOK LINK

01 · FROM THE VIDEO

Short summary

- The teacher reads Matthew 14:22-36. Jesus sends the disciples ahead by boat and goes up the mountain to pray. In the fourth watch of the night He comes to them walking on the sea. Peter asks to come to Him on the water, walks, sees the wind, sinks, and is caught. The disciples worship Him, saying, 'You are truly God's Son!' At Gennesaret the sick are healed by touching the fringe of His garment.
- Why the hurry? John explains: after the feeding the people said, 'This is truly the Prophet,' and were about to take Him by force to make Him king (John 6:14-15). Jesus sends the disciples away and withdraws.
- The boat is 'battered,' a word that literally means tormented. Jesus says, 'it is I,' the same self-identification as God's 'I AM' (Exodus 3:14). The video argues Peter's 'if' means 'since': not a test of Jesus' identity but a request to do what his Rabbi does.
- The scene retells the Exodus: Moses tells the people not to fear and God splits the sea (Exodus 14); Psalm 77 says God's way was in the sea; Job 9:8 says God alone 'tramples down the waves of the sea.' Jesus is the new Moses and also the God who controls the water.
- Peter is afraid of the wind, not the water, and doubts, like the double-minded man of James 1. The lesson: Jesus expects His students to trust Him and what He is doing in and through their lives.

> *"Lord, since it is you, please enable me to do the same thing you are doing.*
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)

> *"Jesus is also the God who controls the water.*
>
> From the video (auto-captions, lightly cleaned)



He came to them, walking on the sea

James Tissot, Jesus Walks on the Sea, 1886-1894. Brooklyn Museum via Wikimedia Commons, public domain

Ask what was expected

The teacher's question for the scene: when Jesus says 'Come!', what is He expecting Peter to accomplish? The answer points to the lesson for the original audience.

The video reads from another English translation. Quotations on this page are from the LSB.

02 · FROM THE VIDEO · LSB TEXT

Scripture passages covered

The video reads all of Matthew 14:22-36 and turns to John 6, Exodus 3 and 14, Psalm 77, Job 9, James 1 and Malachi 4. Each link opens those verses on read.lsbible.org.

Matthew 14:22-36
Read in full: the storm, the walk on the water, and Gennesaret.

John 6:14-21
They wanted to make Him king.

Mark 6:45-56
Mark's account; 'their heart was hardened.'

Exodus 3:13-14
I AM WHO I AM.

Exodus 14:13-31
Do not fear; the sea split.

Psalms 77:16-20
Your way was in the sea.

Job 9:8
He tramples down the waves of the sea.

James 1:5-8
The one who doubts is like the surf of the sea.

Malachi 4:2
Healing in its wings.

Luke 6:40
Like his teacher.

Matthew 15:1-28
Coming next: traditions and the Canaanite woman.

Key verses in the LSB

“But immediately Jesus spoke to them, saying, “Take courage, it is I; do not be afraid.””
Matthew 14:27 (LSB)

“And immediately Jesus stretched out His hand and took hold of him, and *said to him, “You of little faith, why did you doubt?””
Matthew 14:31 (LSB)

“Who alone stretches out the heavens / And tramples down the waves of the sea;”
Job 9:8 (LSB)

03 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

The storm and the confession

A crowd that wanted a king, a battered boat, and 'it is I.'

JOHN 6:14-15

Why the hurry?

👑 JOHN 6:14-15 (LSB)

CONTEXT

“Therefore when the people saw the sign which He had done, they were saying, “This is truly the Prophet who is to come into the world.” So Jesus, knowing that they were going to come and take Him by force to make Him king, withdrew again to the mountain by Himself alone.”

FROM THE VIDEO 'Immediately He made the disciples get into the boat' (14:22). John explains the urgency: the crowd drew the right conclusion from Deuteronomy 18 but wanted to crown Him by force.

FROM THE VIDEO Jesus dismisses the crowd and goes up the mountain alone to pray.

◆ Factbook: Prayer ◆ Factbook: Messiah

MATTHEW 14:24

Battered by the waves

🌊 MATTHEW 14:24-25 (LSB)

TORMENTED

“But the boat was already many stadia away from the land, being battered by the waves; for the wind was against them. And in the fourth watch of the night He came to them, walking on the sea.”

FROM THE VIDEO The word for 'battered' literally means tormented. The video says it describes demonic hostility in Matthew 8 and Revelation 9:5. Revelation 9:5

FROM THE VIDEO Earlier the video noted that Jews linked the sea with the watery chaos of Genesis 1:2, and that at 8:26 Jesus rebuked the wind and the sea. Genesis 1:2 Matthew 8:26

BACKGROUND The fourth watch is about 3 to 6 in the morning; they had been rowing most of the night.

◆ Factbook: Sea of Galilee ◆ Factbook: Abyss

MATTHEW 14:26-27

It is a ghost! / It is I

JESUS · MATTHEW 14:27

“But immediately Jesus spoke to them, saying, “Take courage, it is I; do not be afraid.””

GOD · EXODUS 3:14

“And God said to Moses, “I AM WHO I AM”; and He said, “Thus you shall say to the sons of Israel, ‘I AM has sent me to you.’””

FROM THE VIDEO In Greek 'it is I' is egō eimi, literally 'I am.' The video hears in it how God identified Himself to Moses.

BACKGROUND Egō eimi can also be an ordinary 'it's me.' On the sea, after a feeding in the wilderness, many readers hear more.

◆ Factbook: Moses

MATTHEW 14:33

You are truly God's Son!

⛵ MATTHEW 14:32-33 (LSB) FIRST

“And when they got into the boat, the wind stopped. And those who were in the boat worshiped Him, saying, “You are truly God’s Son!””

FROM THE VIDEO This is the first time the disciples use the title Son of God for their Rabbi. Yet Mark adds that 'they had not gained any insight about the loaves, but their heart was hardened' (Mark 6:52). Mark 6:52

◆ Factbook: God the Son ◆ Factbook: Worship

> *“Jesus is also the God who controls the water.*
>
> From the video

04 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

The God who walks on the sea

Exodus 14, Psalm 77, Job 9, and the fringe of His garment.

EXODUS 14:13, 21, 31

Do not fear; the sea is split

MOSES · EXODUS 14:13

“But Moses said to the people, “Do not fear! Stand by and see the salvation of Yahweh which He will accomplish for you today; for the Egyptians whom you have seen today, you will never see them again forever.”

MOSES · EXODUS 14:21

“Then Moses stretched out his hand over the sea; and Yahweh swept the sea back by a strong east wind all night and made the sea into dry ground, so the waters were split.”

FROM THE VIDEO Moses exerted control over the chaotic sea by the power of God; Jesus as the new Moses exerts the same control. Moses says 'Do not fear!' and Jesus says 'do not be afraid' (14:27).

FROM THE VIDEO At the end of Exodus 14 the people 'believed in Yahweh and in His servant Moses' (Exodus 14:31); in the boat the disciples worship Jesus.

◆ Factbook: The Exodus ◆ Factbook: Moses

PSALM 77:16-20

Your way was in the sea

👣 PSALMS 77:19-20 (LSB) REMEZ

“Your way was in the sea / And Your paths in the mighty waters, / But Your footprints were not known. / You led Your people like a flock / By the hand of Moses and Aaron.”

FROM THE VIDEO Asaph describes the Exodus with God Himself present, walking a path through the sea, while Moses leads the people. It is not merely that Jesus is the new Moses: He is also the God who controls the water.

◆ Factbook: Book of Psalms



JOB 9:8

He tramples down the waves

🌊 JOB 9:8 (LSB)

ONLY GOD

“Who alone stretches out the heavens / And tramples down the waves of the sea;”

FROM THE VIDEO The Old Testament describes God as the one who walks on top of the sea, and 'alone.' The disciples are seeing this with their own eyes.



MATTHEW 14:34-36

The fringe of His garment

MATTHEW · MATTHEW 14:36

“and they were pleading with Him that they might just touch the fringe of His garment; and as many as touched it were cured.”

MALACHI · MALACHI 4:2

““But for you who fear My name, the sun of righteousness will rise with healing in its wings; and you will go forth and skip about like calves from the stall.”

FROM THE VIDEO The people want to do what the hemorrhaging woman did (9:20-21). The video says Malachi 4:2 led people to expect healing from the Messiah's 'wings,' an idiom for the corners of a garment where the tassels hang. Matthew 9:20-21

BACKGROUND The Law commanded tassels on the corners of garments to remember the commandments (Numbers 15:38-39). Numbers 15:38-39

◆ Factbook: Tassel (tzitzit) ◆ Factbook: Malachi ◆ Factbook: Healing



Walking on the waters

Ivan Aivazovsky, Walking on the Waters, 1888. Wikimedia Commons, public domain

> *Every disciple wants to be like their teacher.*
>
> From the video

05 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND · LSB TEXT

Peter on the water

Wanting to be like the Teacher, seeing the wind, and trusting Him.

🤦

MATTHEW 14:28-29

Lord, command me to come

🤦 MATTHEW 14:28-29 (LSB) PETER

“And Peter answered and said to Him, “Lord, if it is You, command me to come to You on the water.” And He said, “Come!” And getting out of the boat, Peter walked on the water and came toward Jesus.”

FROM THE VIDEO The video argues 'if' should read 'since': Peter is not testing who Jesus is but asking to do what his Rabbi does. Every disciple wants to be like their teacher (Luke 6:40).

FROM THE VIDEO With Craig Blomberg: 'Lord, since it is you, please enable me to do the same thing you are doing.' That can be the disciple's prayer for life.

◆ Factbook: Peter (Simon Peter) ◆ Factbook: Rabbi



MATTHEW 14:30-31

Seeing the wind

😨 MATTHEW 14:30-31 (LSB)

DOUBT

“But seeing the wind, he became frightened, and beginning to sink, he cried out, saying, “Lord, save me!” And immediately Jesus stretched out His hand and took hold of him, and *said to him, “You of little faith, why did you doubt?””

FROM THE VIDEO Peter did not fear the water; he feared the wind. Was it the strength of the storm, or other spiritual forces on the sea? The video says we are not sure.

FROM THE VIDEO Then Jesus says Peter doubted: he did not trust the One who called him out of the boat.

◆ Factbook: Peter (Simon Peter)



JAMES 1:6-8

Like the surf of the sea

🌀 JAMES 1:6-8 (LSB)

DOUBLE-MINDED

“But he must ask in faith, doubting nothing, for the one who doubts is like the surf of the sea, driven and tossed by the wind. For that man ought not to expect that he will receive anything from the Lord, being a double-minded man, unstable in all his ways.”

FROM THE VIDEO James uses the same picture: the doubter is tossed by the wind like the sea Peter is sinking into.

◆ Factbook: James (brother of Jesus)



THE LESSON

Trust Him and what He is doing

FROM THE VIDEO Jesus expects His students to trust Him and what He is doing in and through their lives. Whether they need food, shelter, wisdom or insight, He gives what they need, so they can trust Him.

FROM THE VIDEO Even when He calls Peter out of the boat, and later calls them to come and die for Him, He gives His disciples everything they need to do what He calls them to do. The video recalls Bonhoeffer's line that when Christ calls a man, He bids him come and die.

◆ Factbook: Disciples



Lord, save me!

James Tissot, Saint Peter Walks on the Sea, 1886-1894. Brooklyn Museum via Wikimedia Commons, public domain

> *Lord, since it is you, please enable me to do the same thing you are doing.*
>
> **Craig Blomberg, as quoted in the video**

06

Who's who in 14:22-36

What the video says, then a short background note.

Jesus

VIDEO Prays alone, walks on the sea, says 'it is I,' and catches Peter.

BACKGROUND Mark adds that He 'was intending to pass by them' (Mark 6:48), language used of God

Simon Peter

VIDEO Asks to come on the water, walks, fears the wind, and sinks.

BACKGROUND Only Matthew records Peter's walk on the water.

passing by Moses and Elijah.

Mark 6:48 | Exodus 33:22 | ◆ Jesus Christ | ◆ God the Son | ◆ Jesus walks on water

Matthew 16:16 | ◆ Peter (Simon Peter)

The disciples

VIDEO Terrified, then worship Him: 'You are truly God's Son!'

BACKGROUND Mark says their heart was hardened (Mark 6:52).

Mark 6:52 | ◆ Disciples | ◆ The Twelve

The crowd

VIDEO Wanted to take Him by force to make Him king (John 6:15).

BACKGROUND They expected a political deliverer.

John 6:15

The people of Gennesaret

VIDEO Recognize Him and bring all who were sick.

BACKGROUND The plain of Gennesaret lay on the north-west shore between Magdala and Capernaum.

Mark 6:53-56 | ◆ Sea of Galilee

Asaph

VIDEO The psalmist of Psalm 77, who describes God's path through the sea.

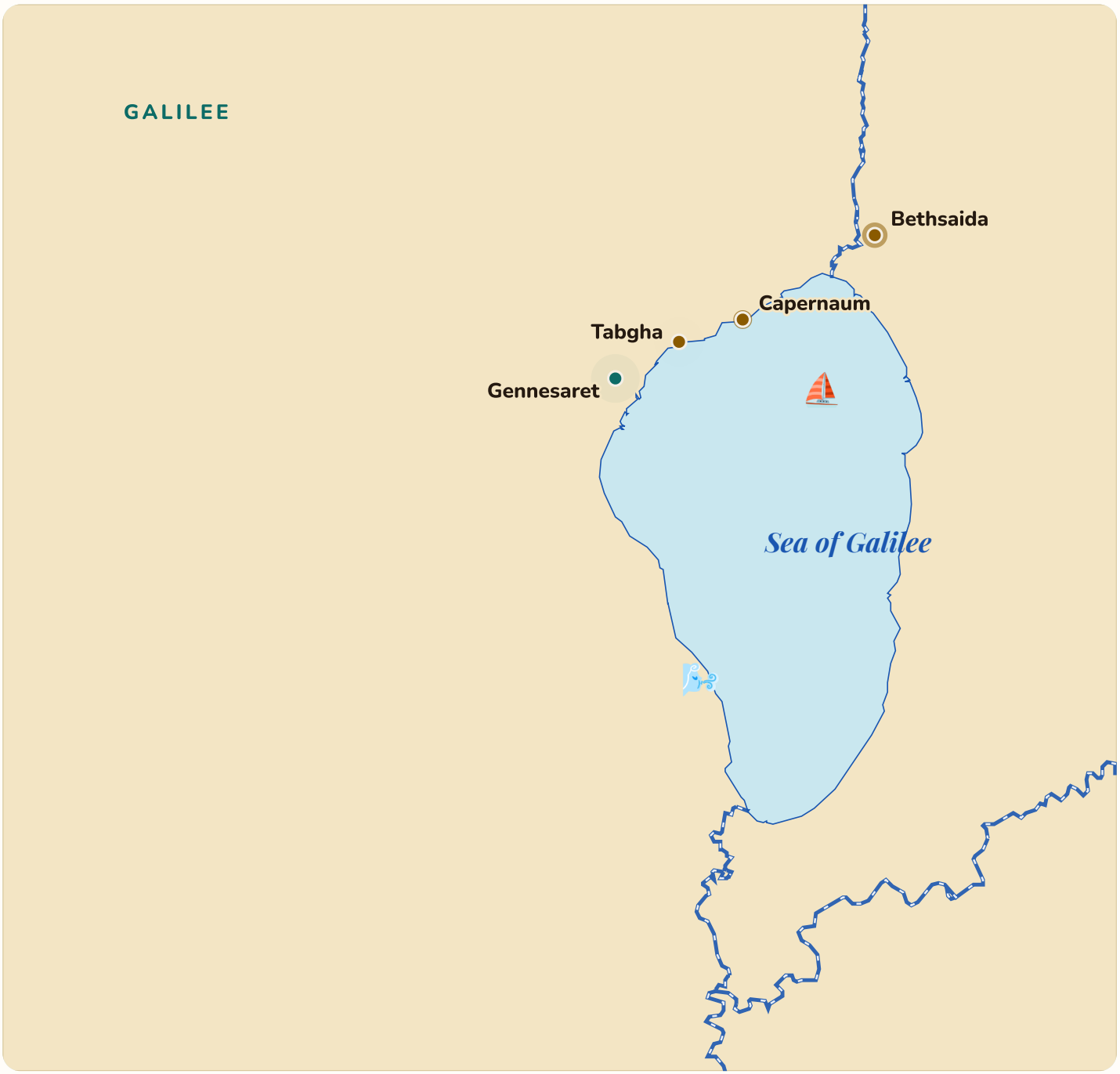
BACKGROUND A Levite musician in David's time; twelve psalms carry his name (Psalms 50; 73-83).

1 Chronicles 16:5 | ◆ Book of Psalms | ◆ Asaph

07 · FROM THE VIDEO · BACKGROUND

Across the lake

Gold pins are background; the pins outlined in the video's color are places the video names.



● Named in the video ● Background

Positions from known sites; Bethsaida's exact site is debated. Lake outline and Jordan River: OpenStreetMap contributors (ODbL).

Bethsaida BACKGROUND

Mark says Jesus sent the disciples ahead 'to the other side to Bethsaida' (Mark 6:45).

◆ Factbook: Bethsaida

Capernaum BACKGROUND

John says they were going across the sea to Capernaum (John 6:17).

◆ Factbook: Capernaum

Tabgha BACKGROUND

The traditional site of the feeding on the north-west shore.

◆ Factbook: Tabgha

Gennesaret VIDEO

Where they landed and the sick touched the fringe of His garment (14:34-36).

◆ Factbook: Sea of Galilee

08

Key terms

Fourth watch

BACKGROUND

The Roman night was split into four watches; the fourth ran from about 3 to 6 in the morning.

◆ Factbook: Watch (of the night)

Stadia

BACKGROUND

Plural of stadion, about 185 meters; John says they had rowed 25 or 30 stadia (John 6:19).

Egō eimi

VIDEO

'I am,' rendered 'it is I'; the video hears God's name from Exodus 3:14. The captions write 'egoi.'

New Moses

VIDEO

The video's theme: Jesus retells the Exodus as the prophet like Moses.

◆ Factbook: Moses

Little faith

VIDEO

Matthew's word for disciples who trust, but not enough (6:30; 8:26; 16:8).

Fringe

VIDEO

The tassel on the corner of a garment, commanded in Numbers 15:38.

◆ Factbook: Tassel (tzitzit)

Remez

VIDEO

A hint back to an Old Testament passage.

◆ Factbook: Tanakh

09 · BACKGROUND

Hebrew and Greek words

Strong's numbers match the LSB's own word tagging for the verses listed. Glosses summarize the standard lexicons; 'Look up' points you to the entry to read for yourself (BDAG for Greek; BDB or HALOT for Hebrew).

βασανίζω

basanizō G928

φάντασμα

phantasma G5326

To torment; of a boat, to buffet or batter. Look up: BDAG, βασανίζω.

Greek · Matt 14:24

Apparition, ghost.

Greek · Matt 14:26

θαρσέω

tharseō `G2293`

To take courage, be of good cheer.

Greek · Matt 14:27

εἰ

ei `G1487`

If; with the indicative it assumes the condition for the sake of argument, which is why some render it 'since.'

Greek · Matt 14:28

ὀλιγόπιστος

oligopistos `G3640`

Of little faith.

Greek · Matt 14:31

διστάζω

distazō `G1365`

To doubt, waver, be of two minds.

Greek · Matt 14:31

κράσπεδον

kraspedon `G2899`

Edge, fringe, tassel of a garment.

Greek · Matt 14:36

◆ Factbook: Tassel (tzitzit)

כָּנָף

kanaph `H3671`

Wing; also the corner or skirt of a garment. Look up: BDB or HALOT, כָּנָף.

Hebrew · Mal 4:2

◆ Factbook: Tassel (tzitzit)

דָּרַךְ

darak `H1869`

To tread, trample, march.

Hebrew · Job 9:8

10

Historical and cultural background

ESTABLISHED **Facts most interpreters agree on**

Storms on the lake

The Sea of Galilee lies about 210 meters below sea level, ringed by hills. Winds funnel down the valleys, especially in the evening, and can raise sudden high waves.

The Galilee boat

In 1986 a first-century fishing boat was found in the mud near Magdala: about 8 meters long and 2.3 wide, it could carry a crew of about a dozen. A boat like it helps picture the disciples rowing all night.

Tassels

Jewish men wore tassels (tzitzit) on the four corners of the outer garment, with a cord of blue, to remember the commandments (Numbers 15:38-39). Jesus wore them too.

Night watches

Jews traditionally counted three night watches; Matthew and Mark use the Roman system of four (Mark 13:35).

SOURCED Early witnesses

> *To teach us, that loneliness and retirement is good, when we are to pray to God.*

John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 50, on 14:23. Nicene and Post-Nicene Fathers, series 1, vol. 10 (public domain).

> *He said not, Pray and entreat, but, bid. Do you see how great his ardor, how great his faith?*

John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 50, on 14:28. NPNF 1.10 (public domain).

> *For he not only believed that He was able Himself to walk on the sea, but that He could lead upon it others also; and he longs to be quickly near Him.*

John Chrysostom, c. AD 390. Homilies on Matthew 50, on 14:28-29. NPNF 1.10 (public domain).

DEBATED Where scholars differ

'If' or 'since'?

The video reads Peter's 'if it is You' as 'since.' Greek 'if' with the indicative presents the condition as assumed for the argument, without asserting it is true. Most translations keep 'if'; Chrysostom, like the video, sees ardor and faith, not testing.

How much does 'it is I' carry?

Some read egō eimi here as a plain 'it's me.' Others, noting Job 9:8 and Psalm 77, hear the divine name. Mark's 'He was intending to pass by them' (Mark 6:48) strengthens the second reading for many.

What did Peter fear?

Most see simple fear of the storm. The video suggests spiritual forces might have been in view but says we are not sure.

CAREFUL READING Small slips in the video

Small slips worth knowing (offered gently; the video's main points stand):

- The video says the word for 'battered' describes demonic hostility in Matthew 8:6. There it describes the centurion's servant, 'paralyzed at home, fearfully tormented' (8:6), an illness; demons use the word at 8:29: 'Have You come here to torment us before the time?'
- Reading Peter's 'if' as 'since' over-reads the Greek. A first-class condition assumes the statement for the argument; it does not translate as 'since,' and the context of fear (14:26) allows real uncertainty.
- That many Jews believed the gateway to the underworld lay beneath the Sea of Galilee is stated without a source; we could not confirm it.
- The expectation that the Messiah would heal through His tassels, drawn from Malachi 4:2, is found in later and popular teaching; the first-century evidence for it is thin.
- Craig Blomberg's rendering is given as the video reports it, and the Bonhoeffer line is the video's paraphrase; we could not check either.
- The captions write 'Janzerat' and 'Janzaret' for Gennesaret, 'egoi' for egō, 'Asaf' for Asaph, 'Bonhaofer' for Bonhoeffer, and 'Blombberg' for Blomberg.

II · BACKGROUND

From the Red Sea to Chrysostom

Coral dots mark what Matthew 14:22-36 echoes or this episode covers. Early dates are approximate; dates tagged debated vary among scholars.

c. 1446 BC DEBATED

God splits the sea; 'Do not fear!'

Exodus 14:13-31 *Remez: 14:27*

c. 2000-1000 BC DEBATED

Job: God 'tramples down the waves of the sea'

Job 9:8 *Remez: 14:25*

c. 1000-586 BC DEBATED

Asaph: 'Your way was in the sea'

Psalms 77:16-20 *Remez*

c. 430 BC DEBATED

Malachi: healing in its wings

Malachi 4:2

c. AD 29 DEBATED

Jesus walks on the sea; 'You are truly God's Son!'

Matthew 14:22-33 *This episode*

c. AD 29 DEBATED

Healings at Gennesaret

Matthew 14:34-36 *This episode*

c. AD 390

Chrysostom: 'how great his ardor, how great his faith'

Matthew 14:28

12

Cross-references

Added cross-references for further study.

Matthew 8:23-27
The earlier storm
ADDED

Mark 6:45-56
Mark's parallel
ADDED

John 6:15-21
John's parallel
ADDED

Psalms 107:23-30
He caused the storm to stand still
ADDED

Isaiah 43:1-3
When you pass through the waters
ADDED

Matthew 16:13-17
Peter's confession
ADDED

James 1:2-8
Faith without doubting
ADDED

Numbers 15:37-41
Tassels on garments
ADDED

13

Reflection and discussion

0 of 6 questions marked done on this device.

1 ☐ Why might Jesus have sent the disciples into a storm right after feeding the crowd?

2 ☐ What do Exodus 14, Psalm 77 and Job 9 add to your reading of this scene?

3 ☐ Do you read Peter's request as testing or as wanting to be like his Teacher?

4 ☐ What is the 'wind' that makes you look away from Jesus?

5 ☐ Where is Jesus calling you 'out of the boat' right now?

6 ☐ How has He already given you what you need for what He is asking of you?

14

Application

FROM THE VIDEO

What is Jesus expecting Peter to accomplish when He says 'Come'? The lesson for the original audience: Jesus expects His students to trust Him and what He is doing in and through their lives. Whatever Jesus is doing, the disciples can trust that He satisfies all their needs; they had just seen the feeding of the five thousand. Whether they need food or shelter or wisdom or insight, Jesus gives His disciples what they need so they can trust Him and what He is doing in and through their lives, even when He calls Peter out of the boat to walk on the water, and even when He later calls them to come and die for Him. In the midst of all of it, Jesus gives His disciples everything they need to accomplish what He is calling them to do. Lord, since it is You, please enable me to do the same thing You are doing.

STUDY NOTE (ADDED)

read Psalm 77 in full. Asaph starts in distress and remembers the Exodus; notice where his attention turns, then compare Peter seeing the wind.

> *"Jesus expects his students to trust him and what he's doing in and through their lives.*
>
> From the video

15

Look it up in Logos

Each link opens that person, place or topic in the Logos Factbook, inside the Logos app on iPad, Mac or PC. The same links are in Copy all notes.

◆ Jesus Christ ◆ David ◆ Moses ◆ Jordan River ◆ Malachi ◆ Isaiah ◆ Wilderness

◆ The Exodus ◆ Galilee ◆ Righteousness ◆ Elijah (prophet) ◆ Capernaum ◆ Book of Deuteronomy

◆ Book of Psalms ◆ Worship ◆ God the Son ◆ John Chrysostom ◆ Bethsaida ◆ Demon possession

◆ Disciples ◆ Fishing ◆ Healing ◆ Law of Moses ◆ Magdala ◆ Prayer ◆ Sea of Galilee

◆ Peter (Simon Peter) ◆ Tabgha ◆ Abyss ◆ Centurion ◆ James (brother of Jesus) ◆ Tanakh

◆ Messiah ◆ Rabbi ◆ Tassel (tzitzit) ◆ Aaron ◆ Asaph ◆ Jesus feeds the 5,000 ◆ Job (man of Uz) ◆ Watch (of the night) ◆ Jesus walks on water

Source: the video's auto-generated YouTube captions, read in full. Scripture quotations are from the Legacy Standard Bible, copyright 2021 by The Lockman Foundation. All rights reserved. Chrysostom: Nicene and Post-Nicene Fathers (public domain). Images: Wikimedia Commons (James Tissot, Brooklyn Museum; Ivan Aivazovsky; public domain). Map data: OpenStreetMap contributors (ODbL).

Offline copy. Live page: https://shea-nelson.github.io/workout-app/bible/matthew-28/